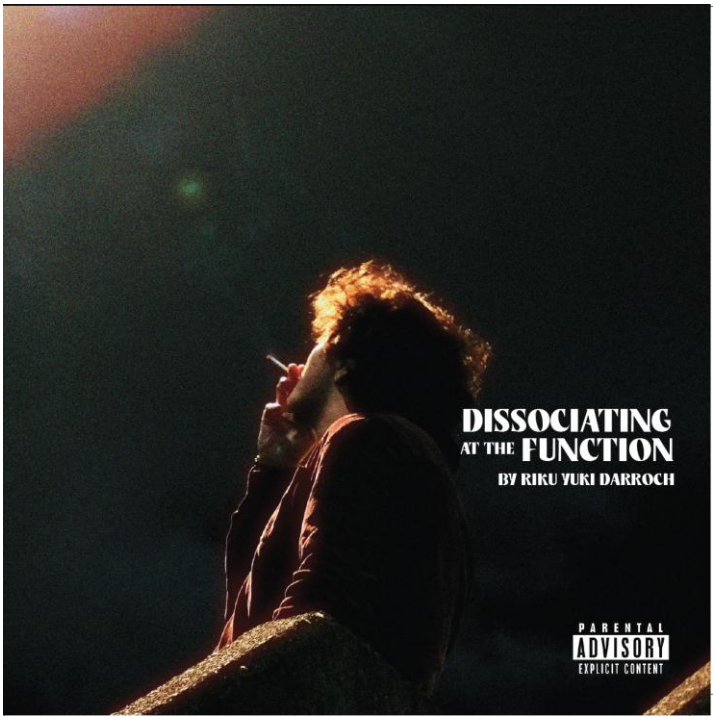
COMD302 P2 Riku Yuki Darroch Process Document

Rationale

The typeface I chose for this assignment is Black Lettering. Originally in the exercise I made a craft beer design, however I reworked the project and made a branding image of a hip-hop artist. For a different course that I am doing this trimester (COMD201), I designed a CD Jewel Case of an album based on a song I am currently making. Therefore, in this project I decided to expand on that and use black lettering to create 3 pieces of collateral based on my album. The 3 pieces I decided on were an alternative cover art for the album, a gig poster, and a hoodie. Although Blackletter is well known for being associated with the rock and metal subcultures, the way it has been used by anti-conformist movements translated to hip-hop particularly in the 90s. The brand image I wanted to go for in this project was to use hip-hop's relationship with blackletter and modernize it with clean graphic design.

About the album

The CD case album I designed for COMD201 is based on a song I am making called "Dissociating At The Function", it takes inspiration from Modern Alternative Conscious Hip-hop and R&B. The core themes of the song are the struggles with money and mental health struggles particularly with social anxiety and depression. Therefore, the album that I imagined around this song delves deeper into these themes and includes political commentary, economic hardship and identity. Below is the album cover I produced for the project.



Alternative Album Cover

I started with finding a blackletter font online that I liked. The one I settled on was **UnifrakturCook** from Google Fonts.

I particularly liked the boldness of the font and the low contrast of line thickness. The name of the album was also legible with the font.

I opened photoshop and with the transform tool, created a subtle spiral effect on the text that really encapsulated the core themes of the album.

My main inspiration for this design decision was the clothing brand Anti-Social Social Club and their logo having a similar wavy effect on the type.

I was also looking at already existing hip hop album covers that contain Black Lettering, Including Nas' "Illmatic", Drake's "Honestly Nevermind", and Outkast's "Aquemini.

I particularly liked the color scheme of "honestly nevermind" however not so much the drippy hard to read rendering on the type.

I then found this tutorial on YouTube that puts a smooth shiny chrome texture onto text that I liked the effect of.

https://youtu.be/rwsrt7hgPIw

Chrome also being a common motif in the graphic design of hip-hop especially in the 90s as seen on the album covers above. Therefore, I followed it to produce these variations.

I did like the low opacity backdrop version of the album title because it blurred the edges of the text and invoked the foggy dissociative theme of the album, however it made the text less legible and therefore I chose the version of the title that had sparkles as my favorite.

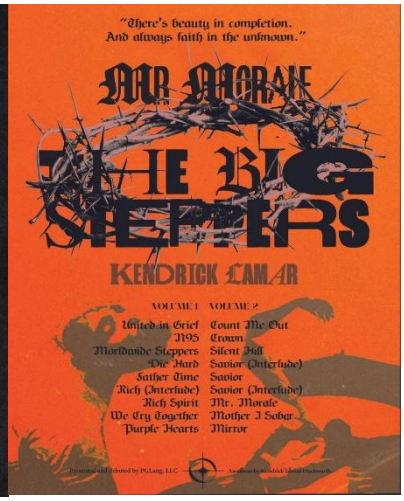
I added this text in indesign and produced these three variations of the album cover.

My intention with black space was to further invoke the theme of dissociating at an event. The idea was that a given person dissociates/spirals in the corner of a room, therefore, to have the spiral logo in the corner of the album cover invoked that same message. Also, the black space above the room entails the crushing weight of pressure of social interaction, however it is empty as if the subject created the threat from nothing. The parental advisory logo is a industry convention for albums published that feature vulgar language, it wasn't necessary to add in this project because this isn't getting published but it is often associated with hip-hop albums so I included it on that basis.

With this rationale I liked the middle option the most.

Gig Poster

The two main inspirations of the gig poster were these two images I found online.



What I appreciated the most was the gridding on the Rufus Du Sol poster and the way that the track names are layed out on the Kendrick Lamar and the Big Steppers tour poster. According to the assignment instructions each piece of collateral must speak to each other, yet use different text. Therefore instead of using the album name as the focal point of the poster, I instead opted to use the artist's name. Which is mine.

However I found a problem with the font that I had chosen for my album logo, in **UnifrakturCook** K's look like F's and capital I's look like J's.

There is likely a historic reason for this but what is important is that the poster is legible for a modern audience. I then found a similar black letter font on Google Fonts called Pirata One which types my name like this:

Riku Yuki Darroch

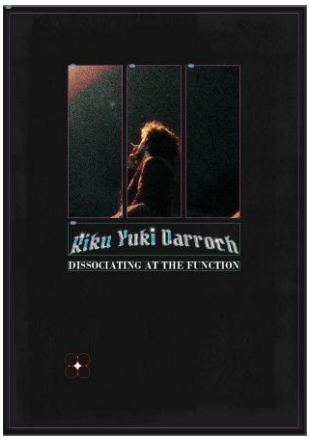
Therefore, using this text and the techniques I used for the logo design on the album cover I produced these outcomes:

Riku Yuki Darroch

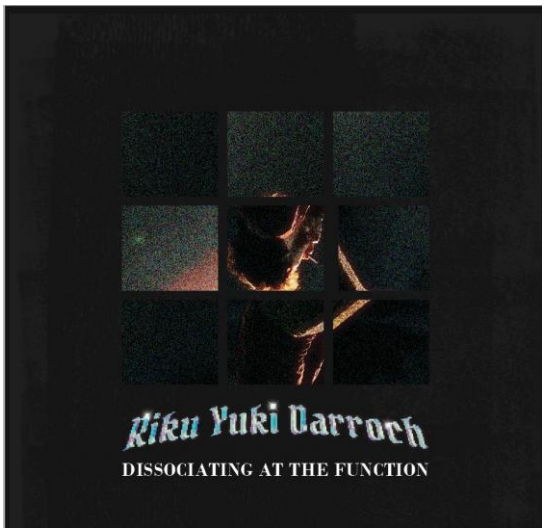
Riku Yuki Darroch

This logo does not feature the spiral motif of the last logo, this is because the text was not legible unless the effect was so subtle that it wasn't noticeable. However the slight curve that the logo is in creates a powerful effect as if it was captured at a low angle.

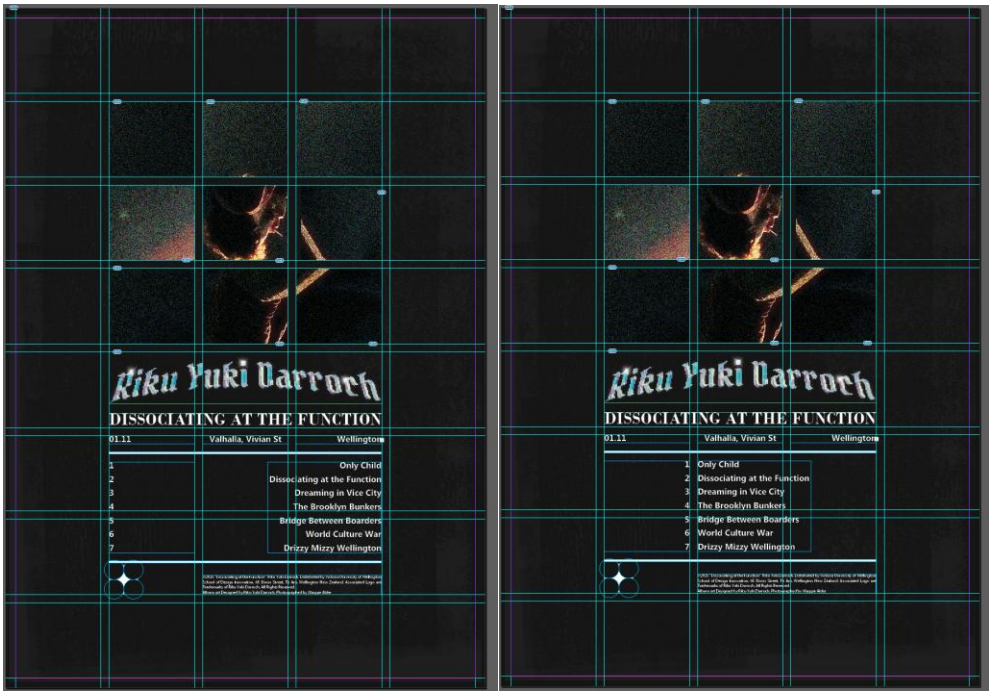
Taking inspiration from the Rufus Du Sol poster, I produced this poster.



I liked the colors, the texture of the paper, and the inclusion of the original album cover photo I took, however it didn't invoke the themes of the album quite enough. After playing around with the layout I then produced this outcome.

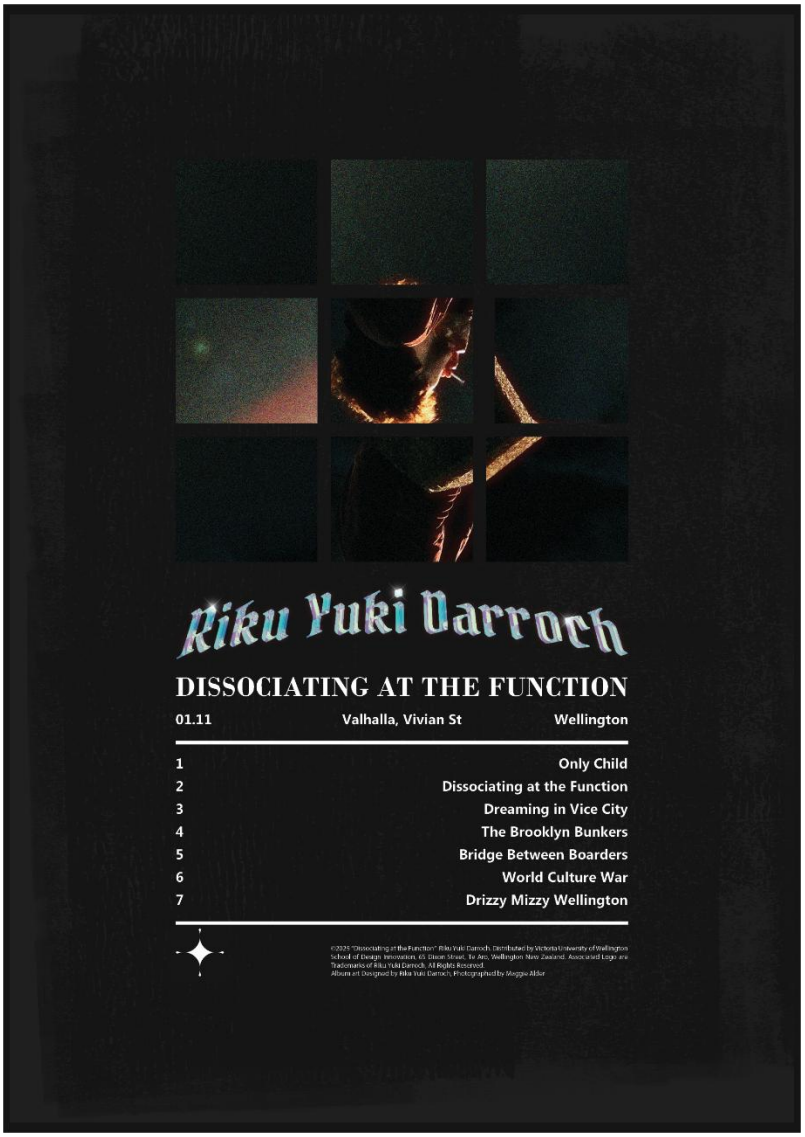


Where the album cover is broken into segments and scattered randomly like a Rubix cube. The intention was to create a sense of disconnection to reality for the poster. After settling on this I added the rest of the text to the poster in these two variations



Although it's a tough decision, I like the first layout a little better because it emphasizes the grid layout a bit more than the second. The information on the poster was made up for this project, however Valhalla is a place where my friends have performed before, the show

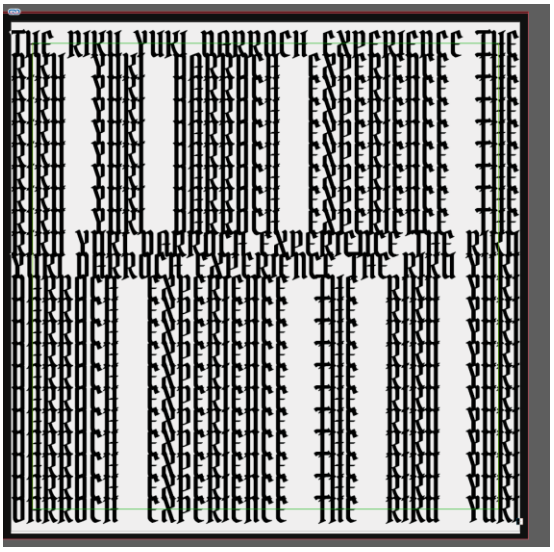
date is my birthday, the tracklist is the one I created for the CD case project, and the copyright information is based on a template I found online. The shine symbol on the bottom left corner is a simple shape I made for a project in DSDN371, I have been including it in this poster as a made up label logo.

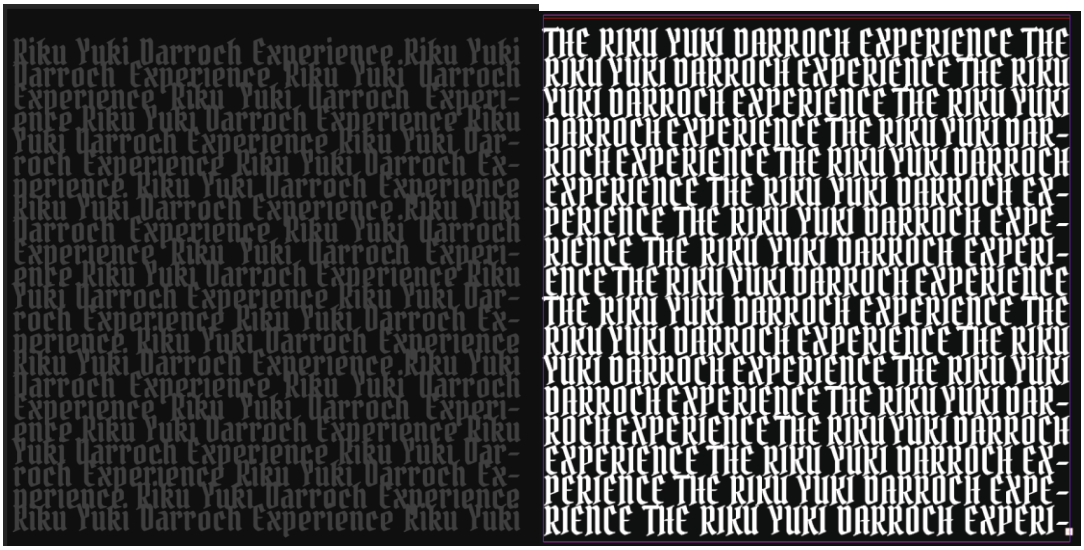


Hoodie Design

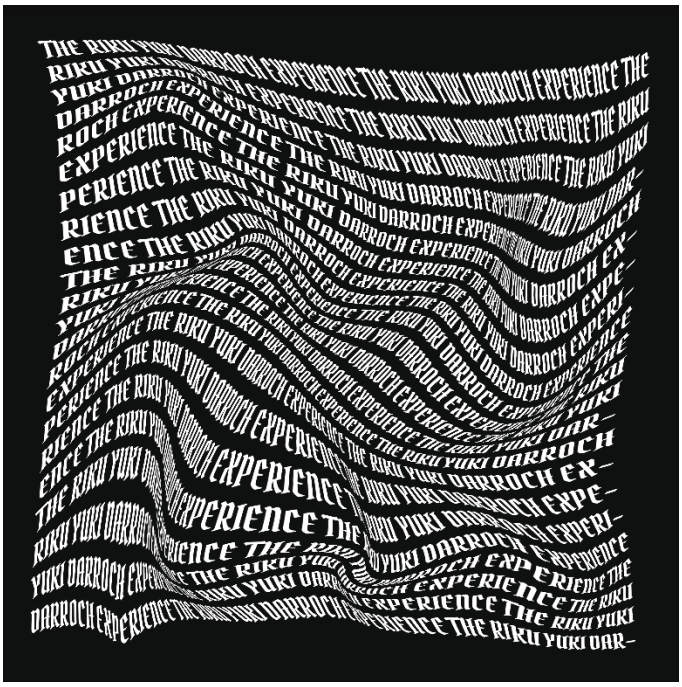
At the beginning of the year my girlfriend and I went op shopping for some new clothes and I found this shirt by Zambesi. Throughout the course of this trimester I always thought that it was an interesting usage of typography in graphic design. An added feature is that the design glows in the dark. The text is warped and overlayed on it's self so that the actual letters are hard to read but I wanted to use this as inspiration for my own design at some point.

Therefore I began by opening indesign and creating a square of text repeating the phrase "The Riku Yuki Darroch Experience" using the same Pirata One font.




Riku Yuki Darroch Experience.Riku Yuki
Darroch Experience.Riku Yuki Darroch
Experience.Riku Yuki Darroch Experi-
ence.Riku Yuki Darroch Experience.Riku
Yuki Darroch Experience.Riku Yuki Dar-
roch Experience.Riku Yuki Darroch Ex-
perience.Riku Yuki Darroch Experience

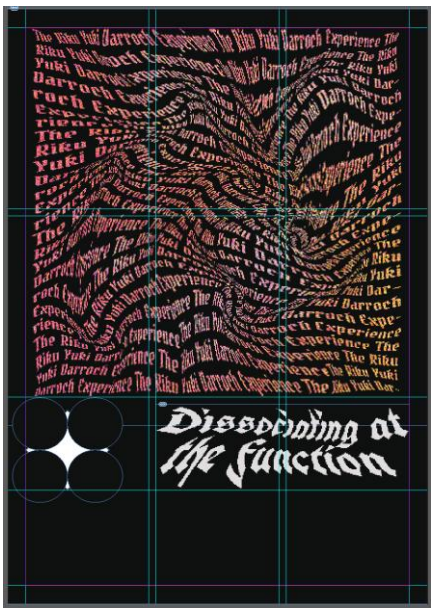
I was a fan of this direction so I went deeper and produced this.



I liked how the shape of the text warping was profound in this variation, however I wasn’t sure about the uneven edges of the design and how it would look on a t-shirt, therefore I tried again from scratch and produced this variation.

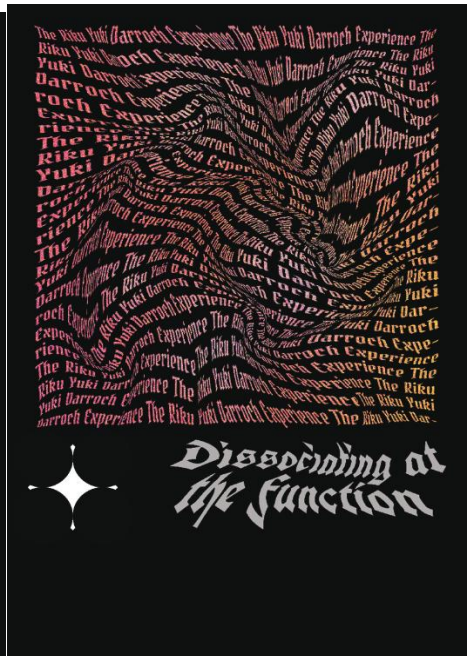
The spiral motif is really exemplified in this design, to a point that gives the implication of a bubbling pit of emotions. I think it really resonates with the core theme of the album. However to differentiate it from the T-Shirt a bit more, I played with different Layer Types, Gradients and Filters and created this:

This design reminded me of the Anti-Social Social Club hoodies. I opened this design on InDesign and then produced this layout.



I was happy with this, however for the front side of the hoodie, it needed a design, therefore I used the same font as the album cover and same techniques once again to create this logo.

RYDE being an acronym for Riku Yuki Darroch Experience. This logo I put on Indesign to be used as a front side design



Reflection

During this trimester, throughout this course I struggled to wrap my head around typography and graphic design. It took up two of my courses and the most challenging aspect of it was the fact that we were not allowed to do any illustrations. I came to Wellington and joined this university to give me an opportunity to learn to draw as drawing is my passion. That is why I have struggled so much in this course. However, something that was unexpected was how much I learned from this course that I can apply to my drawing. The distribution of information, usage of negative space, off balance composition, these are things that I learned this trimester that I am now eager to put into practice in illustrating.

I am glad to finally produce some work in this course that I am proud of. I am also glad that this course gave me an opportunity to combine my interests of hip-hop and my school and allowed me to produce something that I can use for myself one day if I am ready to use it.